

io.netty.handler.codec.EncoderException when evaluating too many entity selectors in chat preview

[MC-251889](#) NETWORKING

Status	Resolved / Fixed
Affected	1.19 Pre-release 1
Fixed in	1.19 Pre-release 2
Reported	2022-05-18
Mojira category	Networking

REPRODUCTION TARGET

Use version:

1.19 Pre-release 1

Affected versions (1):

1.19 Pre-release 1

Environment:

Minecraft Java Edition using an unmodified vanilla dedicated server and a client both running exactly 1.19 Pre-release 1. A local server on the same computer is the simplest deterministic arrangement, using localhost as the address. Use a newly generated normal/default world with no plugins, proxy, custom server implementation, or datapacks. Java 17 is required for this Minecraft version. The report does not specify a world seed, game mode, difficulty, or minimum entity count.

PRECONDITIONS

- The Minecraft Launcher can run the historical Java Edition version 1.19 Pre-release 1; snapshots/pre-releases are enabled in the launcher's Installations screen.
- The vanilla dedicated-server JAR for exactly 1.19 Pre-release 1 is available in a separate test directory and is not a 1.19 Pre-release 2 or later server.
- Java 17 is installed and available through the command line.
- The server EULA can be accepted before starting the test server.
- The client and server use the same affected version, 1.19 Pre-release 1.
- Chat preview is enabled in server.properties with the exact property previews-chat=true.
- The test player is granted operator permissions so that the client accepts and previews the /say command.
- The client-side Chat Preview option is enabled.
- Only one trigger attempt is necessary; do not repeatedly reconnect and reproduce the exception after the observation subsystem has captured it.

STEPS TO REPRODUCE

1 INFERRED

In the Minecraft Launcher, open Installations, enable the option that shows snapshots if necessary, and create or select an installation whose version is exactly 1.19 Pre-release 1. Do not select the fixed version 1.19 Pre-release 2.

INPUT `1.19 Pre-release 1`

SUCCESS CUE The selected launcher installation explicitly displays 1.19 Pre-release 1.

2 INFERRED

Create an empty directory for the dedicated test server. Place the vanilla 1.19 Pre-release 1 server JAR in this directory and, for the commands below, name it server.jar. Open a terminal or command prompt with this directory as its working directory.

INPUT `server.jar`

SUCCESS CUE The working directory contains the affected-version server JAR named server.jar.

3 INFERRED

Run the server once to generate its configuration files. Enter the command in the terminal from the server directory. This first launch should stop because the EULA has not yet been accepted.

INPUT `java -Xms1G -Xmx1G -jar server.jar nogui`

SUCCESS CUE The server directory now contains eula.txt and server.properties, and the server process has stopped or reports that the EULA must be accepted.

4 INFERRED

Open eula.txt in a plain-text editor. After reviewing and accepting the Minecraft EULA, replace eula=false with eula=true, then save the file without changing its filename.

INPUT `eula=true`

SUCCESS CUE The saved eula.txt contains the line eula=true.

5 VERIFIED

While the server is stopped, open server.properties in a plain-text editor. Find the previews-chat property and set it to true. If the generated file does not already contain the property, add it as its own line. Save the file.

INPUT `previews-chat=true`

SUCCESS CUE The saved server.properties contains exactly one active previews-chat=true line.

6 INFERRED

Start the dedicated server again from its directory using the Java command. Leave this terminal open because it is also the server console.

INPUT `java -Xms1G -Xmx1G -jar server.jar nogui`

SUCCESS CUE The console reports that server startup is complete, normally with a line containing Done, and remains ready to accept console input.

7 **REPORT**

Launch Minecraft Java Edition using the launcher installation selected in step 1. At the title screen, verify that the displayed version is 1.19 Pre-release 1.

SUCCESS CUE The Minecraft title screen identifies the running client as 1.19 Pre-release 1.

8 **VERIFIED**

Before joining the server, open Options, then Chat Settings. Locate Chat Preview and toggle it to ON. Return to the title screen after confirming the setting.

INPUT Options -> Chat Settings -> Chat Preview: ON

SUCCESS CUE Chat Preview is displayed as ON in Chat Settings.

9 **INFERRED**

From the title screen, select Multiplayer and use Direct Connection or Add Server. For a server running on the same computer, enter localhost as the server address and join it. If the server is on another computer, enter that server's reachable address instead.

INPUT localhost

SUCCESS CUE The player has joined the dedicated server, surrounding terrain has rendered, and normal player movement responds without initial chunk-loading delay.

10 **INFERRED**

In the dedicated-server console, grant the connected test player operator permissions so /say is available to that player. Replace <playername> with the exact in-game player name. Because this is entered in the server console, do not include a leading slash.

INPUT op <playername>

SUCCESS CUE The server console confirms that the named player was made a server operator, and the player remains connected.

11 **REPORT**

Leave the player in the normally generated world. Do not clear entities, switch to a void world, install plugins, or otherwise reduce the ordinary loaded entity population. Wait until nearby chunks are rendered and movement is responsive before opening chat.

SUCCESS CUE The player is standing in a normally generated, fully loaded area of the server world with no loading pause in progress.

12 **REPORT**

Press the Open Chat control, which is T by default. Begin the command by typing /say followed by one entity selector. Do not press Enter; the command must remain in the chat edit box so chat preview evaluates it while it is being typed.

INPUT /say @e

SUCCESS CUE The chat screen remains open, /say @e is visible in the edit box, and the command has not been submitted.

13 **INFERRED**

Pause briefly until the chat preview has had an opportunity to update for the current text. Continue only when the client UI is responsive; do not press Enter at any point.

SUCCESS CUE The chat screen is still active and ready for another token to be typed after the current preview request.

14 **REPORT** **TRIGGER**

Append a space followed by another @e selector to the existing command. Add selectors one at a time rather than submitting the command. After each complete token, briefly allow chat preview to process it, then append another identical token. First build toward the report's concrete ten-selector example; if the observation subsystem has not yet signaled completion, continue adding one space-plus-@e token at a time. Do not press Enter. The individual append that causes the oversized preview response is the trigger action.

INPUT Append " @e" repeatedly, producing: /say @e @e @e @e @e @e @e @e @e @e ...

SUCCESS CUE Immediately after each append, the unsent command contains one additional complete @e token and a new chat-preview evaluation has been initiated.

HANDOFF TO OBSERVATION

During step 14, hand control to the observation subsystem immediately after each additional complete " @e" token is appended while the chat screen remains in command-editing mode. The command must still be unsent, Chat Preview must remain enabled, and Enter must not be pressed. The observation subsystem should monitor the client connection state and dedicated-server console while selector tokens are added, and should stop further input after capturing the first trigger occurrence.

UNCERTAINTIES

- The report does not state an exact selector count that always reaches the oversized-preview threshold. It gives ten selectors as a concrete example but says to continue typing @e until the trigger occurs; the necessary count can vary with the number and representation of entities currently loaded.
- The report describes a normal world but provides no seed, coordinates, game mode, difficulty, or required entity population. The plan therefore uses a fresh default server world and does not artificially add or remove entities.
- The report says to create a server but does not explicitly distinguish vanilla dedicated server software from other server implementations. A vanilla dedicated server is selected because the supplied stack trace identifies the affected vanilla server JAR and this avoids plugin or proxy interference.
- Operator status is not explicitly listed in the report. It is added as a practical execution requirement so the player can type a valid /say command and receive its chat preview rather than being blocked by command permissions.
- Typing selectors sequentially is preserved from the report. Pasting a fully constructed command may issue a different number or timing of preview requests and is therefore not used.
- The fixed version 1.19 Pre-release 2 must not be used for reproduction, even though it appears in the report as a fix version.

MANUAL RESULT

Version used	
Reproduced?	YES / NO / PARTIAL
Trigger reached?	YES / NO
Crash file	
Notes	
Tested by / date	